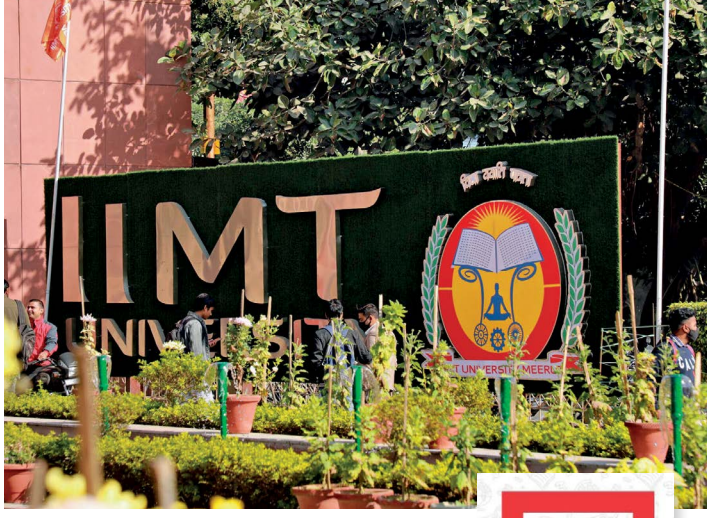


▶ UTTAR PRADESH

Shared Ideal of Learning

Real-world media training joins hands with academic rigour in the ITMI-IIMT alliance

THE COLLABORATION BETWEEN the India Today Media Institute (ITMI) and IIMT University, Greater Noida Campus, marks a significant step in aligning academic learning with industry-driven media education.

Formalised through a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU), this partnership brings ITMI's well-established one-year Postgraduate Program in Digital Media & Communication to students of IIMT University, beginning in the 2026 academic session.

Takeaways

- **The India Today Media Institute (ITMI) brings its one-year PG programme in digital media to IIMT Univ.**
- **AI, data journalism, social media focus areas**

PRACTICE MEETS THEORY

At the heart of this association is a shared vision: to integrate academic rigour with real-world media training. The curriculum is designed to reflect the evolving demands of the digital media ecosystem. It encompasses areas such as digital journalism, social media strategy, multimedia storytelling, content creation, web development, Articial Intelligence and data analytics. Regular workshops, masterclasses and interactions with industry professionals further enrich the learning experience, keeping students aligned with current trends as well as technologies.

For ITMI, the collaboration represents an opportunity to expand the reach of its proven training model while maintaining the integrity of its programme. The larger purpose is to redefine how media education is delivered in India.

For IIMT University, it brings immediate access to an established, industry-integrated curriculum without the need to build one from scratch. More importantly, it allows its students to experience a professional training environment that goes beyond traditional classroom boundaries. ■

By **Ajay Sukumaran**

IN SOOLIKUNTE VILLAGE, ON THE SOUTHEAST edge of Bengaluru—where the city has been creeping up on him over the years—Gopal Reddy is raising chrysanthemum seedlings in his two-acre polyhouse. In a couple of months, when the 200,000-odd plants mature, he can harvest about 17,000 bunches of flowers that will fetch upwards of Rs 250 each in the market. "We are making good money," says Reddy, who alternatively plants gerbera, roses and gypsophila. His problem is the plot itself: it's now worth several crores. Earmarked for acquisition in 2007 for the 73-km Peripheral Ring Road (PRR) project, it has remained locked in over the past two decades.

That grand project has come out of a limbo owing to a renewed push by deputy chief minister D.K. Shivakumar; he says it can reduce Bengaluru's dreaded traffic snarls by up to 40 per cent. Originally conceived by the Bangalore Development Authority (BDA) in the mid-2000s as part of perimeter-wise links for the main highways radiating out of the city—enabling cross-city traffic to bypass the core—the PRR's 73 km are to be the northern arc that would integrate with the privately-operated NICE road in the south to complete a new outer ring road, wider than the existing one that carries the name. Now rebranded as the Bengaluru Business Corridor (BBC), it's planned as an eight-lane tolled expressway with plotted commercial development along nearly 34 km of its length.

SIX TIMES COSTLIER

The estimated cost, however, has ballooned to Rs 27,000 crore, about six times the original estimate, with over 75 per cent of it going towards that worsening migraine: land acquisition. "This is a new chapter. We want to complete this new road in two years," Shivakumar had said in October, as the state greenlit an augmented compensation package for land losers. He pitched it as the cost of indecision by past governments; funds will now come via a tie-up with HUDCO.

In February, the deputy CM said 400 land owners had been compensated, indicating the project was finally making headway. As March passed, tenders for road construction have been invited. The three-phase project, going west to east, needs a total of 2,418 acres.